

The Battle of Vicksburg

Turning Point on the Mississippi River

U.S. CIVIL WAR · 1863

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Period: 7



SIEGE OF VICKSBURG.

Background: The Fortress City

What

The Battle of Vicksburg was important as it gave the control of the Mississippi river to the union, leading to the splitting of the confederates to two sides.

When

Siege: **May 18 – July 4, 1863**

It was a 47 day siege

Where

Vicksburg, Mississippi — in and around Warren County Mississippi.

Why It Matters

Union control of Vicksburg meant control of the entire Mississippi — It gave control to the union as it was one of the main supply line and unions were able to cut off trade to confederacy.

LAKE PROVIDENCE EXP.
FEB 3 - MAR 29

GRANT'S CANAL
JAN 24 - MAR 27

VICKSBURG



Key Events & Timeline

March 1st 1863

Grant takes the beachhead on the east site of the Mississippi

1

2

May 14, 1863

Battle of Jackson, Union forces capture the state capital, cutting the rail lines feeding Vicksburg

3

May 16, 1863

Battle of Champion Hill, The bloodiest battle of the campaign, Union army forced Confederate army to retreat into the Vicksburg defense.

4

May 18 – June 1863

Union army general Grant digs 15 miles of trenches.

5

July 4, 1863

Gen. Pemberton surrenders, the Confederate general to the union forced by non stop shelling and starving the Confederates.



Strategy & Importance



Benefit

Controlled Mississippi River controlling the supplies and food going to the confederates.

Geographical advantage

The city were on the bluff giving the unions protection with the rounded cover.

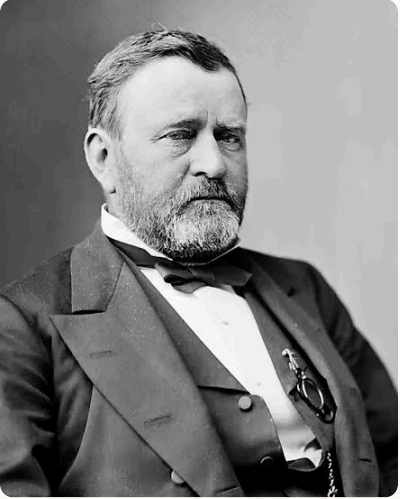
Confederate Goal

To hold the rest of the rails and river links for the troops to travel.

Why Siege Tactics?

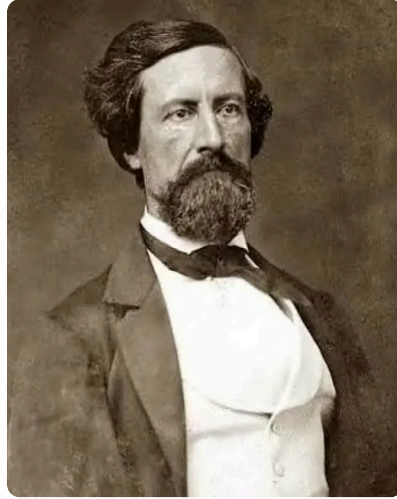
Because it avoided casualties as they can starve out the Confederates.

Key Leaders & Voices from the Time



Ulysses S. Grant

Union Commander — Daring Campaign and relentless 47 day siege taking surrender of the Confederate from Vicksburg.



John C. Pemberton

Confederate Commander — held onto Vicksburg as long as possible before surrendering, as people and army starved.



Abraham Lincoln

U.S. President — The hold of the Mississippi River gave the union an advantage dividing confederates into 2 parts.

"The Father of Waters again goes unvexed to the sea."

— Abraham Lincoln, celebrating Union victory at Vicksburg



Impact of the Victory



Confederacy Split

Union controls the entire Mississippi River — Dividing the Confederates into 2 parts.



Military Advantage

Confederate western armies isolated as supplies didn't move through the Mississippi River. But Union moves troops and supplies freely by river.



Shift in Morale

The victory at Vicksburg gave a huge morale boost to the Union and Northern Morale.



Long-Term Legacy

It was considered the turning point of the civil war, with this victory, they also freed a lot of slaves, leading to the enforcement of the Emancipation Proclamation.

Multimedia: Bringing Vicksburg to Life



 YouTube



Here's Why the Battle of Vicksburg Was So Important

Marching through Mississippi, Ulysses S. Grant focused his efforts on the city of Vicksburg. Surrounding and firing upon the city for weeks on end, he forced its...

 03:43

Conclusion

1 47 Days That Changed the War

The Siege of Vicksburg ended July 4, 1863 — a huge Union Victory.

2 A Confederacy Cut in Two

With the Unions control on the Mississippi River, Cut the Confederacy territory into two dividing its power.

3 Grant's Defining Campaign

Vicksburg's victory got Ulysses S. Grant promoted to major general, later became the 18th president.

4 Why It Still Matters

Vicksburg shaped the war's outcome as it was the turning point of the Civil War.



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